

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

(STANDARD GK)

INDIA & THE WORLD

MODULE - 5

INDIA ... WORLD HERITAGE SITES
NATURAL & MIXED

WORLD HERITAGE SITES

SALIENT POINTS



United Nations
Educational, Scientific and
Cultural Organization



World
Heritage
Convention

- Every year, April 18 is marked as World Heritage Day. It is dedicated to creating awareness about protecting and preserving various sites around the world that have achieved World Heritage Status.
- It is classified as natural or manmade area of international importance and which requires special protection.
- India has a total of 36 (28 cultural, 7 natural and 1 mixed properties) inscribed on the World Heritage List.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES – NATURAL & MIXED



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

1. GREAT HIMALAYAN NATIONAL PARK CONSERVATION AREA



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

1. GREAT HIMALAYAN NATIONAL PARK CONSERVATION AREA

SALIENT POINTS

- Himachal Pradesh is characterized by high alpine peaks, alpine meadows and riverine forests.
- Several Beas river tributaries like Tirthan, Sainj originate here.
- It protects the monsoon-affected forests and alpine meadows of the Himalayan front ranges.
- It also protects part of Conservation International's Himalaya "biodiversity hot spot".
- It is also part of the BirdLife International's Western Himalaya Endemic Bird Area.



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

1. GREAT HIMALAYAN NATIONAL PARK CONSERVATION AREA



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

Learning Space

2. KAZIRANGA NATIONAL PARK



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

2. KAZIRANGA NATIONAL PARK



SALIENT POINTS

- Kaziranga National Park hosts two-thirds of the world's great one-horned Rhinoceros.
- It also boasts the highest density of tigers among the protected areas of the world. Declared a Tiger Reserve in 2006.
- It is also home to large breeding populations of elephants, wild water buffalo and swamp deer.
- It is in Assam, Wet alluvial grasslands occupy nearly two-thirds of the park area.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

Learning Space

2. KAZIRANGA NATIONAL PARK



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

2. KAZIRANGA NATIONAL PARK



SALIENT POINTS

- River fluctuations by the Brahmaputra River system result in spectacular examples of riverine and fluvial processes.
- The National Park area was enlarged to the north to include part of River Brahmaputra but the enhanced area has not been proposed for inclusion within the World Heritage Property.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

Learning Space

3. KEOLADEO NATIONAL PARK



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

3. KEOLADEO NATIONAL PARK

SALIENT POINTS

- It's previous name was Bharatpur Bird Sanctuary.
- It is world's most important bird breeding and feeding grounds.
- It originated as Royal Hunting Reserve during 1850s and was a game reserve for Maharajas and British.
- In 1982, Keoladeo was declared as a National Park, declared as World Heritage Site in 1985 by UNESCO, home to around 370 species of birds and animals.
- Most important ones are Basking Python, Painted Storks, Deer, Nilgai.



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

Learning Space

3. KEOLADEO NATIONAL PARK



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

3. KEOLADEO NATIONAL PARK

SALIENT POINTS



- It was also known as the breeding ground for the rare and elusive to spot Siberian crane.
- Major wintering areas for large numbers of aquatic birds from Afghanistan, Turkmenistan, China and Siberia.
- It is Bird Paradise and developed in a natural depression wetland that was managed as a duck shooting reserve at the end of the 19th century.
- The wet lands are maintained from the water traditionally provided from the “Ajan Bandh” reservoir.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

Learning Space

4. MANAS WILDLIFE SANCTUARY



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

4. MANAS WILDLIFE SANCTUARY



SALIENT POINTS

- Situated in Assam on the gentle slope in the foothills of the Himalayas.
- It is a biodiversity hotspot, spans the Manas river and is bounded to the north by the forests of Bhutan.
- It spans on either side of majestic Manas River.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

Learning Space

4. MANAS WILDLIFE SANCTUARY



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

4. MANAS WILDLIFE SANCTUARY



SALIENT POINTS

- It's northern boundary is contiguous to the international border of Bhutan.
- The Manas-Beki system is the major river system flowing through the property and joining the Brahmaputra river.
- It is rich biodiversity area and it has got spectacular scenery and natural landscape also.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

5. SUNDARBANS NATIONAL PARK



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

5. SUNDARBANS NATIONAL PARK



SALIENT POINTS

- Sundarbans contains world's largest mangrove forests located at the mouth of Ganges and Brahmaputra Rivers between India and Bangladesh.
- The Mangrove habitat supports the single largest population of tigers in the world.
- Great economic importance as a storm barrier, shore stabilizer, nutrient and sediment trap.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

5. SUNDARBANS NATIONAL PARK



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

5. SUNDARBANS NATIONAL PARK



SALIENT POINTS

- Around 55 percent is forest and 45 percent wetlands in the form of tidal rivers, creeks and canals.
- Largest area of Mangrove forest in the world and it is the only one that is inhabited by tiger.
- It is situated in the larger UNESCO biosphere reserve.
- It is well protected and largely undisturbed.
- It is surrounded by three wild life sanctuaries.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

6. NANDA DEVI AND VALLEY OF FLOWERS NATIONAL PARKS



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

6. NANDA DEVI AND VALLEY OF FLOWERS NATIONAL PARKS



SALIENT POINTS

- They are in Uttarakhand, possess two core areas about 20 kms apart made up by Nanda Devi National Park and Valley of Flowers National Park.
- Valley of Flowers is renowned for its meadows of endemic alpine flowers.
- It is also home to rare and endangered animals like Asiatic Black Bear, Snow Leopard, Brown Bear and Blue Sheep.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

6. NANDA DEVI AND VALLEY OF FLOWERS NATIONAL PARKS



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

6. NANDA DEVI AND VALLEY OF FLOWERS NATIONAL PARKS



SALIENT POINTS

- They are in the high altitude West Himalayan landscapes. Nanda Devi National Park is dominated by 7,817 meters peak of Nanda Devi, India's second highest mountain.
- They are naturally well protected because of their remoteness and limited access.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

Learning Space

7. WESTERN GHATS



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

7. WESTERN GHATS

SALIENT POINTS

- They have an exceptionally high level of biological diversity and recognized as one of the world's eight "hottest hotspots" of biological diversity.
- These influence Indian monsoon system, spread across six states of Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Goa, Maharashtra and Gujarat.
- Approximately 30 to 50 kms inland from Indian West Coast, cover an area of 1,40,000 km², length is around 1,600 kms, only interrupted by 30 km Palghat Gap at around 11°N.



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

Learning Space

7. WESTERN GHATS



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - NATURAL

7. WESTERN GHATS

SALIENT POINTS



- Western Ghats at some locations represent non-equatorial tropical evergreen forests in the world.
- At least 325 globally threatened as per IUCN Red Data List, occur in Western Ghats.
- Exceptional levels of plant and animal diversity.
- Out of nearly 650 tree species found in Western Ghats, 54% are endemic.
- Similarly, animal diversity with endemic ratio of 53% to 65% is very high.
- Endangered species such as the lion-tailed Macaque, Nilgiri Tahr and Nilgiri Langur occur in this area.

WORLD HERITAGE SITES - MIXED

8. KHANGCHENDZONGA NATIONAL PARK



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - MIXED

1. KHANGCHENDZONGA NATIONAL PARK

SALIENT POINTS

- It is at the heart of Himalayan range in northern India in the state of Sikkim.
- It has got unique diversity of plains, valleys, lakes, glaciers, snow-capped mountains etc.
- It includes the world's third highest peak, Mount Khangchendzonga.
- Got lakes and glaciers, including the 26 km long Zemu Glacier.
- It falls within the Himalaya Global Biodiversity Hotspot. Covers 25% area of Sikkim.



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - MIXED

8. KHANGCHENDZONGA NATIONAL PARK



WORLD HERITAGE SITES - MIXED

1. KHANGCHENDZONGA NATIONAL PARK

SALIENT POINTS

- The abode of mountain deity on Mt Khangchendzonga is central to the Buddhist understanding of Sikkim as a Beyul i.e., an intact site of religious ritual and cultural practice for Tibetan Buddhists in Sikkim.
- Remarkable six Cat species are available within the park, which include Leopard, Clouded Leopard, Snow Leopard, Jungle Cat, Golden Cat, Leopard Cat.



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